

Tim Elam

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Summary

Engineering leader for regulated B2B SaaS, FinTech, and AI/cloud products, with 10+ years across Head of Engineering, CTO, Director, founder, and senior engineering roles. Builds teams and delivery systems while staying close to architecture, production reliability, compliance, and business outcomes.

Work Experience

StartProto

Feb. 2026 - Present

Head of Engineering

Atlanta, Georgia

Scope: End-to-end ownership of MCP, Public API, FedRAMP Moderate readiness, AI assistant architecture, ephemeral environments, E2E testing, and observability modernization.

Tech Stack: Python, TypeScript, React, FastAPI, MongoDB, AWS, AWS GovCloud, AWS Bedrock, ECS, Lambda, CloudFront/WAF, Datadog, Langfuse, Playwright, and MCP.

- Owned MCP and Public API programs end-to-end, designing agent-safe read/write access, production API surfaces, and OAuth scopes for controlled access to StartProto data.
- Led FedRAMP Moderate readiness across GovCloud architecture, AWS evidence, boundary decisions, TLS/KMS/secrets reviews, Orca/Datadog integration, and assessor-ready policy artifacts.
- Architected AI assistant capabilities and modernized observability across Datadog, Langfuse, and Bedrock traces, hardening streaming, conversation recovery, routing, and production debugging.
- Introduced ephemeral frontend/backend environments and E2E testing, creating branch previews, release PR workflows, Playwright coverage, and production health checks across frontend, backend, and testing repos.

YouLend

Mar. 2025 - Feb. 2026

Lead Engineer

Scope: First US-based engineering presence supporting US business operations.

Tech Stack: Angular, TypeScript, ASP.NET, C#, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Kubernetes, and AWS.

- Established YouLend's US engineering presence and supported local business operations.
- Delivered hands-on feature development, maintenance, and production support across the lending platform.

Branch Politics

Dec. 2024 - Mar. 2025

CTO

Scope: Early-stage political technology platform; owned product architecture, reliability, and cloud migration.

Tech Stack: NextJS, React, Express.js, Feathers.js, TypeScript, Node.js, OpenAI, MongoDB, Serverless Stack, Heroku, and AWS.

- Automated political candidate research by replacing local scripts with event-driven serverless architecture.
- Increased service reliability with ephemeral environments for end-to-end testing in temporarily provisioned environments.
- Optimized cloud compute costs by migrating applications from Heroku to AWS and archiving unused resources.

DemoFox

Mar. 2023 - Sep. 2024

Founder & CEO

Atlanta, Georgia

Scope: Founder responsible for product, engineering, and commercialization of an AI video collaboration startup.

Tech Stack: Angular, Tailwind CSS, NestJS, TypeScript, Node.js, PostgreSQL, OpenAI, Serverless Framework, and AWS.

- Founded DemoFox, an AI-powered enterprise social video collaboration startup.

UserTesting

Aug. 2021 - Feb. 2023

Director of Engineering

Chamblee, Georgia

Scope: Led 3 teams and a 15-person Test Results engineering organization.

Tech Stack: Angular, TypeScript, Ruby on Rails, GraphQL, MySQL, CloudFormation, and AWS.

- Managed engineering managers and staff engineers through architecture proposals for features such as full-text search.
- Added core domain model lifecycle events to the application event bus, improving long-term architecture flexibility.

UserTesting (continued)

Senior Manager, Engineering

Jul. 2019 - Aug. 2021

Chamblee, Georgia

Scope: Engineering management and technical leadership for analytics, transcript visualization, and frontend modernization.

- Accelerated customer time-to-value with Keyword Maps, a novel aggregate transcript visualization.
- Mentored engineers into senior, staff, principal, and engineering manager roles through tailored growth plans and coaching.
- Revitalized a department-wide legacy AngularJS upgrade with custom monorepo tooling and Cypress visual baseline testing.

Kabbage

Software Development Manager

Apr. 2018 - Mar. 2019

Atlanta, Georgia

Scope: Managed two software and QA teams responsible for the marketing website and signup funnel.

Tech Stack: Angular, TypeScript, ASP.NET, C#, SQL Server, Elastic Beanstalk, and AWS.

- Drafted performance-improvement and career-development plans, coaching team members through individualized goals.

Kabbage (continued)

Senior Software Engineer

Jan. 2015 - Apr. 2018

Atlanta, Georgia

Tech Stack: AngularJS, JavaScript, Django, Python, SQL Server, Elastic Beanstalk, and AWS.

- Directly increased same-day cash advance volume through a redesigned signup flow.
- Architected core product transition from multi-tenant ASP.NET to single-tenant SPAs backed by multi-tenant microservices.

Octane5 International

Django Developer

Apr. 2014 - Dec. 2014

Alpharetta, Georgia

Tech Stack: JavaScript, Django, Python, and PostgreSQL.

- Developed and maintained BrandComply, a specialized brand-license-management CMS platform.

Veloxiti, Inc

Engineer

Jul. 2013 - Apr. 2014

Alpharetta, Georgia

Tech Stack: Play Framework and Java.

- Developed systems for the US Army Civil Information Management program with the US Army Research Laboratory.

Education

Georgia Institute of Technology

Master of Business Administration

2020 - 2023

Atlanta, Georgia

Concentration: Technology Commercialization (TI:GER)

Georgia Southern University

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

2010 - 2013

Statesboro, Georgia

Side Projects

The Cosplay Herald

Aug. 2025 - Sep. 2025

Tech stack: NextJS, React, Tailwind CSS, Sanity CMS, and Vercel.

- Designed, developed, and launched *The Cosplay Herald*, a niche news platform for the competitive cosplay community.